



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Good Shepherd Reformed Episcopal School
School Website: <https://gsstyler.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Good Shepherd Reformed Episcopal School (Tyler, TX 75701) demonstrates a robust Classical education orientation across most of the rubric's categories, with especially strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and Pedagogy signals. The school publicly emphasizes a Christian, Anglican-heritage framework, a Trivium-based curriculum, a Great-Books–styled approach to learning, and liturgical worship through daily chapel. These elements align closely with the Six Essential Elements' Positive Keywords for Religious Foundations, Curriculum, and Pedagogy, and with the School Purpose/Goal emphasis on formation, virtue, and wisdom rather than workforce preparation alone. Evidence from the school's site highlights the medieval Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), the Great Conversation via Adler's Paideia framework, daily Morning Prayer and creeds, and a mission centered on virtue, wisdom, and the worshiping life. See examples of these signals in the site content (Our Mission; Classical Education; Christian Heritage; daily chapel; Paideia references; Latin, history, and Great-Books–oriented curricula) with explicit quotes drawn from multiple public-facing pages.

Overall classification by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL, with a single category (Faculty) that is only somewhat explicit in the public materials. The school strongly adheres to core classical virtues and practices, particularly in religious formation, curricular structure (trivium, Great Conversation), and liturgical worship.

What would move the needle: Because the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL (not Somewhat Classical or Not Classical), there is no mandatory "What would move the needle" section. However, for deeper alignment, the faculty category would benefit from more explicit articulations of teachers as living exemplars and of a formal faculty development model that foregrounds classical pedagogy (see expanded notes in Element 5 below).

Abstract-level takeaway: This school exhibits a clearly classical orientation embedded in a Christian, Anglican framework, with strong evidence of the trivium, Great Books approach, daily chapel, and a formation-first purpose. The one area needing some strengthening is the explicit portrayal and development of the faculty as the living curriculum within a collegiate, classical culture.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials consistently frame education within a Christian, Anglican heritage, emphasizing worship, liturgy, and communal worship life (daily chapel, Morning Prayer, creeds, psalms, canticles, hymns). - The mission explicitly ties education to virtues and transcendent realities (truth, goodness, beauty) and to forming character; the Anglican Christian framework is presented as the clearest context for learning. - The

site notes communal prayer, liturgical practices, and a theology-informed worldview (Daily Offices; hymns; worship calendar).

Positive keyword analysis - Present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; worship; chapel; Morning Prayer; creeds; hymns; psalms; canticles; prayer; liturgy; Anglican heritage; daily chapel; worship life. These map directly to Positive Keyword Indicators for Religious/Metaphysical Foundations (transcendentals, liturgy, worship, creeds) in the lexicon. - Negative keyword indicators (e.g., relativism, secular humanism) are not evidenced in the public materials.

Why this rating - The materials foreground transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) and a liturgical, communal worship framework (chapel, prayers, creeds) anchored in Anglican Christian heritage. This aligns strongly with Classical criteria for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of secular or relativistic signals reinforces CLASSICAL rather than Not Classical.

Notes - The daily chapel and liturgical practices are described in detail (Morning Prayer, the Lord's Prayer, Ten Commandments, Creeds, Psalms), reinforcing liturgical commitments.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Two explicit aims emphasize formation in virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job preparation. Text describes formation in godliness and mastery of fundamental facts/skills as foundational. - The mission articulates equipping students with tools of learning and wisdom of the ages to serve God and neighbor with love, virtue, and strength.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: formation; virtue; wisdom; liberal education; paideia; classical mission; Great Conversation; telos; contemplation; classical heritage; education for leisure/restfulness. These correspond to Positive Keyword Indicators in the lexicon. - Negative keyword indicators: The site does not foreground a workforce- or college-prep-only narrative; rather, it frames education as a life of learning and virtue. The explicit negative signals are not evident.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose centers on formation, virtue, and wisdom in a liberal-arts frame (paideia) rather than a narrow job- or career-metrics focus. This aligns with CLASSICAL rather than Not Classical. The public materials also emphasize the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ends.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum explicitly uses the medieval Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as the guiding framework for education. - Subjects include Bible, Latin (Latin 1–3, with advanced options), Greek may appear as elective; history spanning ancient to modern; Western civilization; classical literature. - Historical breadth includes Greek and Roman World, Medieval World, modern world history, and church history; emphasis on Western civilization. - Great Books / Great Conversation signals exist (Mortimer Adler, The Paideia Proposal; discussion and debate; “great conversation” through reading and discussion). - The curriculum emphasizes primary texts and classical works, formal Latin study, and a strong literature/history program (e.g., Medieval World Literature; Classical World Literature).

Positive keyword analysis - Present: liberal arts; trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; classical languages (Latin); history (Western civilization, Greek/Roman, Medieval World); Latin 3, AP Latin 4; classical literature; hymns and sacred art; art/music (fine arts). These correspond to the lexicon's Positive Keywords for Curriculum. - Negative keyword indicators: No overt replacement of history with social-studies framing; no dominant project-based-first pedagogy; no STEM-first framing observed in material.

Why this rating - The content shows a textbook Classical-Curriculum orientation: Trivium, Great Books, Latin, disciplined study of history and Western civilization, and sacred art/hymnody. This is a robust CLASSICAL alignment.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower grades: singing/chanting and memory-formation practices; restfulness and memory-deepening elements (scholé-like feel) described in the School's broader pedagogical narrative. - Upper grades: Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; opportunities to give speeches and practice rhetoric. The Paideia framework and "great conversation through discussion and debate" are highlighted. - The four pillars (Oratio, Studium, Labor, Recreatio) imply integrated prayer, study, work, and recreation as pedagogical rhythms.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: Socratic seminars/discussion; memorization and recitation; chanting; restfulness; scholé; contemplation; wonder; seminars; oratory; debate; memory work; liturgical calendar integration. These map to Positive Keyword Indicators in Pedagogy. - Negative keyword indicators: No clear evidence of exclusive project-based learning or constructivist approaches; the content is consistent with a traditional, classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The site explicitly describes a continuum from memory/chanting in the lower grades to Socratic discussion and rhetoric in upper grades, with restfulness and contemplation interwoven. This aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy signals rather than Not Classical or purely project-based pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe teachers' roles in general terms (formation through instruction; the school's mission, tools of learning, and virtue-formation), but there is less explicit, public articulation of teachers as the "living curriculum," as a formal faculty culture, or a defined "portrait of teacher" per the classical-education lexicon. - The elementary curriculum emphasizes mastery of fundamentals and formation in godliness, with teachers charged to manage time and develop discipline; this signals strong teacher engagement, but not explicit statements about faculty being the "living curriculum" or a formal faculty-development framework. - The site references the "two aims" for elementary teachers and the "tools of learning," but does not always foreground a formal faculty-culture description matched to the lexicon's positive keywords for Faculty (e.g., "portrait of a teacher," "living curriculum," "great books seminars for faculty," etc.).

Positive keyword analysis - Present: generalized references to teachers as guides and mentors within formation-focused pedagogy; "tools of learning" language; a sense of a classical teacherly role (though not explicitly labeled as "living curriculum"). The explicit, codified phrases from the lexicon (e.g., "living curriculum," "portrait of a teacher," "faculty of friends") are not clearly present in the public-facing materials. - Negative keyword indicators: None obvious in this category from the public materials (no overt anti-classical signals), but the absence of explicit "living curriculum" language lowers the strength of the Classical signal for Faculty.

Why this rating - The evidence suggests a Classical orientation in practice, but the public materials do not robustly present the Faculty dimension with the standard classical keywords. Thus, CLASSICAL would be overstated; the best fit with the material is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, given the strong pedagogical signals elsewhere but only modest explicit faculty-language signals.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school hosts explicit "Resources for Good Shepherd School Parents" and "Classical Education Resources," indicating a structured program of parent formation and community engagement beyond simple enrollment. - Admissions and Parent Resources pages show parent involvement in tour, enrollment processes, and access to book lists, reading materials, curriculum resources, and uniform guides. The site also highlights that parents can visit and engage with the school. - The school positions itself as a community-driven educational ministry with daily chapel and liturgical life, extending to the church partnership (Good Shepherd Reformed Episcopal Church). This signals a broad community framework that includes families and the parish.

Positive keyword analysis - Present: partnership with parents; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; household worship; family liturgy alignment.

These map to Positive Keyword Indicators for Parents & Community. - Negative keyword indicators: None observed in the public materials; there is no indication of a customer-like relationship or minimal parent involvement in formation.

Why this rating - The public-facing content demonstrates robust parent/community engagement in classical aims and formation, aligning with CLASSICAL signals for Element 6.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 5 (Faculty): Introduce and publicly document a formal “living curriculum” framework for teachers and a clear faculty-development model grounded in classical pedagogy. Publish explicit statements about the faculty’s role as mentors, exemplars, and co-educators in the classical tradition, including portraits of teacher ideals and opportunities for faculty seminars on classical methods. This would elevate Element 5 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Element 5 (Faculty) could be strengthened by showcasing teacher professional development grounded in Great Books pedagogy, classical seminars, and regular faculty discourse on Socratic/Paideia techniques.
- Element 5 (Faculty) could also include a concrete, published profile of the ideal teacher and student, aligning with the lexicon’s “portrait of a teacher” and “living curriculum” signals.
- Optional but beneficial: add explicit statements about ongoing faculty collaboration with parents to form a true partnership in the classical project (reinforcing Element 6 signals as well).

Note: The aggregate classification remains CLASSICAL due to strong signals in Categories 1–4 and 6, with Element 5’s improvement potential.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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